

RYAN A. DECKER

Chief, Industrial Output section, Federal Reserve Board of Governors

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, August 2015
M.A. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, December 2013
B.S., B.A. Economics, Political Science (minor Mathematics), Brigham Young University, August 2010

RECENT POSITIONS

Chief, Industrial Output section, Federal Reserve Board, 2024-present:

Manage roughly 20 staff including career development, task allocation and scheduling, performance reviews, and hiring

Supervise the section's three major programs:

Monthly publication of Industrial Production and Capacity Utilization data

Tealbook forecast of the industrial sector

Expanded measurement agenda for evaluating private sector economic data

Direct staff research related to section responsibilities

Pursue active research agenda in entrepreneurship, firm and labor market dynamics, and economic measurement topics

Special Adviser to Governor Adriana Kugler (full time), Federal Reserve Board, 2023-2024

Advised on economic developments and policy decisions

Assisted with FOMC meeting preparation including economic, policy, and special topic "go-round" statements and SEP forecasts

Liaised across Board staff of varying job families or seniority

Monitored daily economic data flow and staff forecast reactions

Conducted special topic analysis of economic and measurement questions

Assisted with public-facing engagements including speech drafting and development

Assisted with governor committee work, especially committees on financial stability and Federal Reserve Bank affairs

Principal Economist, Federal Reserve Board, 2020-2024

Pursued active research agenda in entrepreneurship, firm and labor market dynamics, and economic measurement topics

Managed the staff GDP forecast as "GDP coordinator"

Ran the industrial sector forecast with focus on aircraft, motor vehicles, and oil & gas

Worked on various private sector/nontraditional data initiatives including as a founding member of the ADP-FRB payroll index team

Cowrote special topics for staff forecast materials on topics including small business employment, inventory investment, labor market measurement, industry concentration, and oil & gas production

Worked on special pandemic projects (individually or on small teams), including:

Analysis of industry small business intensity and pandemic exposure

Business dynamics analysis and forecast

Quantification of coverage needs and gaps related to business lending facilities

Member, Conference on Research in Income and Wealth (CRIW), 2019-present

Adjunct professor, University of Maryland College Park, 2016-2018
Economics of Entrepreneurship (ECON 462)

Economist/Senior Economist, Federal Reserve Board, 2015-2020

Economist, Center for Economic Studies, U.S. Census Bureau, 2011-2015 (Pathways Program)

PEER- AND EDITOR-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

“Surging Business Formation in the Pandemic: Causes and Consequences?” 2024. *Brookings Papers on Economic Activity*, Fall 2023. (With John Haltiwanger).

“Boom Town Business Dynamics.” 2024. *Journal of Human Resources* 59 no. 2:627-651. (With Meagan McCollum and Gregory B. Upton Jr.). Previously circulated as “Firm Dynamics and Local Economic Shocks.” FEDS working paper #2020-081.

“Business Exit During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Non-Traditional Measures in Historical Context.” 2022. *Journal of Macroeconomics* 72 (June). (With Leland Crane, Aaron Flaaen, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz). FEDS working paper #2020-089.

“Improving the Accuracy of Economic Measurement with Multiple Data Sources: The Case of Payroll Employment Data.” 2022. In *Big Data for 21st Century Economic Statistics*, eds. Katharine G. Abraham, Ron S. Jarmin, Brian Moyer, and Matthew Shapiro. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz).

“Changing Business Dynamism and Productivity: Shocks vs. Responsiveness.” 2020. *American Economic Review* 110(12): 3952-90. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

“The U.S. Labor Market during the Beginning of the Pandemic Recession.” 2020. *Brookings Papers on Economic Activity* (summer): 3-33. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland D. Crane, John Grigsby, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, Erik Hurst, Christopher Kurz, and Ahu Yildirmaz).

“Where Has All the Skewness Gone? The Decline of High-Growth (Young) Firms.” 2016. *European Economic Review* 86 (July): 4-23. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

“Market Exposure and Endogenous Firm Volatility over the Business Cycle.” 2016. *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics* 8(1): 148-98. (With Pablo N. D’Erasmus and Hernan Moscoso Boedo).

“The Role of Entrepreneurship in U.S. Job Creation and Economic Dynamism.” 2014. *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 28(3): 3-24. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- “Can tariffs spur higher factory floor utilization?” 2025. *FEDS Notes*. (With Robin Braun and Fariha Kamal). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/can-tariffs-spur-higher-factory-floor-utilization-20251031.html>..
- “High Tech Business Entry in the Pandemic Era.” 2024. *FEDS Notes*. (With John Haltiwanger). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/high-tech-business-entry-in-the-pandemic-era-20240419.html>.
- “Rising Markups and Declining Business Dynamism: Evidence From the Industry Cross Section.” 2024. *FEDS Notes*. (With Brian Albrecht). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/rising-markups-and-declining-business-dynamism-evidence-from-the-industry-cross-section-20240308.html>.
- “Payroll Employment at Weekly Frequency.” 2023. *AEA Papers & Proceedings* 113 (May): 203-207.
- “A note on industry concentration measurement.” 2023. *FEDS Notes*. (With Jacob Williams). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/a-note-on-industry-concentration-measurement-20230203.html>.
- “Business entry and exit in the COVID-19 pandemic: A preliminary look at official data.” 2022. *FEDS Notes*. (With John Haltiwanger). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/business-entry-and-exit-in-the-covid-19-pandemic-a-preliminary-look-at-official-data-20220506.html>.
- “Across the Universe: Policy Support for Employment and Revenue in the Pandemic Recession.” 2021. *American Economic Association: Papers & Proceedings* 111 (May): 267-271. (With Robert Kurtzman, Byron Lutz, and Christopher Nekarda). *Note: This is a significantly abbreviated version of FEDS working paper #2020-099.*
- “Tracking the Labor Market with ‘Big Data’.” 2019. *FEDS Notes*. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurtz). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/tracking-the-labor-market-with-big-data-20190920.htm>.
- “Book Review: *Big is Beautiful: Debunking the Myth of Small Business*, by Robert D. Atkinson and Michael Lind.” 2019. *Business Economics* 54:145-147.
- “Leaving Money on the Table: Declining Responsiveness and the Productivity Slowdown.” 2018. *VoxEU*. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron Jarmin, and Javier Miranda). At <https://voxeu.org/article/declining-responsiveness-and-productivity-slowdown>
- “Natural Disasters and the Measurement of Industrial Production: Hurricane Harvey, a Case Study.” 2017. *FEDS Notes*. (With Kimberly Bayard and Charles Gilbert). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/natural-disasters-and-the-measurement-of-industrial-production-hurricane-harvey-a-case-study-20171011.htm>
- “Declining Dynamism, Allocative Efficiency, and the Productivity Slowdown.” 2017. *American Economic Review: Papers & Proceedings* 107(5): 322-6. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

“Declining Business Dynamism: What We Know and the Way Forward.” 2016. *American Economic Review: Papers & Proceedings* 106(5): 203-7. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

“Unraveling the Oil Conundrum: Productivity Improvements and Cost Declines in the U.S. Shale Oil Industry.” 2016. *FEDS Notes*. (With Aaron Flaaen and Maria D. Tito). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econresdata/notes/feds-notes/2016/unraveling-the-oil-conundrum-productivity-improvements-and-cost-declines-in-the-us-shale-oil-industry-20160322.html>.

“The Decline of High-Growth Entrepreneurship.” 2016. *VoxEU*. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron Jarmin, and Javier Miranda). At <http://voxeu.org/article/decline-high-growth-entrepreneurship>.

WORKING PAPERS

“Markups and Business Dynamism across Industries.” 2025. Under resubmission at *International Journal of Industrial Organization*. (With Brian Albrecht). At https://rdeckernet.github.io/website/Albrecht_Decker_Markups.pdf.

“Research with Private Sector Business Microdata: The Case of NETS/D&B.” 2020. *Working paper*. (With Leland Crane). Previously circulated as “Business Dynamics in the National Establishment Time Series (NETS),” FEDS working paper #2019-034.

“Entrepreneurship and State Taxation.” 2018. *Working paper*. (With E. Mark Curtis).

“Collateral Damage: Housing, Entrepreneurship, and Job Creation.” 2015. *Working paper*.

PERMANENT UNPUBLISHED MANUSCRIPTS

“Surging Business Formation in the Pandemic: A Brief Update.” 2024. *Mimeo*. (With John Haltiwanger). At https://rdeckernet.github.io/website/DH_businessformation_update.pdf.

“Tracking Labor Market Developments during the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Preliminary Assessment.” 2020. *Working paper*. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland D. Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz). FEDS working paper #2020-030.

“Using Payroll Processor Microdata to Measure Aggregate Labor Market Activity.” 2018. *Working paper*. (With Tomas Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, Christopher Kurz, and Tyler Radler). FEDS working paper #2018-005.

“An Assessment of the National Establishment Time Series (NETS) Database.” 2017. *Working paper*. (With Keith Barnatchez and Leland Crane). FEDS working paper #2017-110.

“Declining Business Dynamism: Implications for Productivity?” 2016. Hutchins Center Working Paper no. 23. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

“The Secular Decline in Business Dynamism in the U.S.” 2014. *Mimeo*. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Adjunct Professor*, Economics of Entrepreneurship (ECON 462), University of Maryland College Park, 2016-2018
- Teaching Assistant*, Advanced Econometrics (ECON 588), Brigham Young University, Spring 2010
- Teaching Assistant*, Intermediate Econometrics (ECON 388), Brigham Young University, Fall 2009
- Teaching Assistant*, International Relations (PLSC 170/472), Brigham Young University, Fall 2007, Spring 2008, Fall 2008

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

- 2025: The London Symposium at King's College London, CRIW Spring conference (discussant), U.S. Census Bureau Center for Economic Studies, NBER Advancing Economic Measurement conference (scheduled Nov. 2025)
- 2024: NBER Summer Institute (CRIW; discussant), Federal Economic Statistics Advisory Committee (FESAC, discussant), The Austin Symposium
- 2023: Economic Innovation Group, ESCoE, Brookings Papers on Economic Activity (BPEA), NBER Summer Institute (CRIW; discussant), Kent Macro Workshop
- 2022: UK-US Working Group on Dynamism & Opportunity, NBER Summer Institute (CRIW; discussant)
- 2021: Federal Economic Statistics Advisory Committee (FESAC), UNSW CAER Workshop, NBER Summer Institute (CRIW), Brookings Graduate Workshop, OECD Productivity Policy for Places workshop (discussant), ASSA 2021
- 2020: Banca d'Italia & FRB joint conference on nontraditional data, Federal Reserve System Macro conference (discussant), CAED seminar series, ITAM Business School, NBER Summer Institute (entrepreneurship group), Workshop on Entrepreneurial Finance and Innovation (discussant), New York Fed, Southern Methodist University O'Neil Center, ASSA 2020 (presenter and discussant), Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship
- 2019: Brookings Hamilton Project, Federal Reserve System Energy Conference (discussant), JPMCC New Directions in Commodities Research symposium (discussant), CAED, Duke/UNC Entrepreneurship Research Conference (discussant), Resources for the Future, York University, Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship 2019
- 2018: Richmond Fed, Oberlin College, University of Hong Kong, Singapore Management University, Economic History Association (discussant), JPMCC New Directions in Commodities Research symposium, NBER Summer Institute (Entrepreneurship group), OECD/Bank of Canada Global Forum on Productivity, IFN Entrepreneurship and Innovation workshop (presenter and discussant), Union College, National Association of Realtors, George Mason University, Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship 2018, ASSA 2018 (presenter and discussant)
- 2017: Brigham Young University, 2017 Federal Reserve System Energy Meeting, 2017 UNC IDEA Workshop, May 2017 Midwest Macro meetings, NBER State Business Taxation Workshop
- 2016: November 2016 Southern Economics Association meetings, NBER Entrepreneurship and Economic Growth Conference, AREUEA conference (discussant), Drexel University, NBER Entrepreneurship and Economic Growth Pre-Conference
- 2015: George Mason University, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, Federal Reserve Board, Bureau of Labor Statistics, University of Oregon, Brigham Young University, University of Georgia, University of Mississippi, Heritage Foundation Center for Data Analysis

2012-2014: BYU Graduate Student Conference, November 2013 Midwest Macro meetings, 2012 APPAM Fall Research Conference

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee service: *AEJ: Economic Policy*, *AEJ: Macroeconomics*, *American Economic Review*, *AER: Insights*, *BE Journal of Macroeconomics*, *Canadian Journal of Economics*, *Congressional Budget Office draft review*, *Econometrica*, *Economic Inquiry*, *Economic Journal*, *Economica*, *Economics Letters*, *Energy Economics*, *Energy Journal*, *European Economic Review*, *Health Economics*, *International Economic Review*, *Journal of Applied Econometrics*, *Journal of Econometrics*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, *Journal of Economic Growth*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Macroeconomics*, *Journal of Monetary Economics*, *Journal of Money, Credit, & Banking*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Productivity Analysis*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Labour Economics*, *Management Science*, *National Science Foundation*, *National Tax Journal*, *NBER grant proposals*, *Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics*, *Oxford Economic Papers*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Rand Journal of Economics*, *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, *Research Policy*, *Review of Economic Dynamics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Financial Economics*, *Review of Financial Studies*, *Small Business Administration draft study review*, *Small Business Economics*, *Sustainability*, *U.S. Census Bureau/FSRDC proposals*

Program and report committees: Institute Entrepreneurship Trends Report – Ecosystems Advisory Committee (annual report, 2020), Society of Government Economists (2019) ASSA meetings, Mid-West Macroeconomics Spring Meeting (2017)

OTHER POSITIONS

Research Assistant, Prof. John Haltiwanger, University of Maryland at College Park, 2011-2015
Short-Term Consultant, World Bank, 2011
Research Assistant, Prof. Kerk Phillips, Brigham Young University, 2009-2010
Research Assistant, Prof. Scott Cooper, Brigham Young University, 2008-2010
Intern, Office of International Affairs, U.S. Department of the Treasury, 2009

REFERENCES

John Haltiwanger	University of Maryland	halt@umd.edu
Ron Jarmin	U.S. Bureau of the Census	ron.s.jarmin@census.gov
Christopher Kurz	Federal Reserve Board	christopher.j.kurz@frb.gov
Scott Stern	MIT Sloan School	sstern@mit.edu